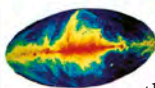


SKY WATCHING



If you look up at the sky on a clear night you can see hundreds of stars and, sometimes, the moon. But if you use binoculars or a telescope you can see even more—for example, the planets and the craters on the moon.

When astronomers study the universe they use huge radio telescopes, some with dishes, to help them to see far, far away, and to gather information from space. The Hubble Space Telescope is the largest telescope to be put into space. It can take clear pictures of stars and galaxies because it orbits 340 miles (547 kilometers) above the Earth's atmosphere.



Clearly Venus

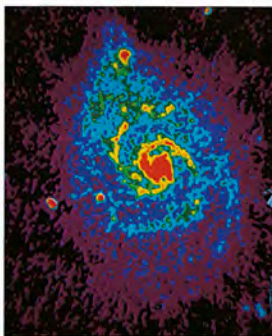
This photograph of Venus was taken by the Pioneer Venus Orbiter. It used radar to get a clear picture through the thick clouds around Venus. The signals were sent back to Earth to a radio telescope where this picture was produced.

Solar panel



Whirligig

This radio map of the Whirlpool galaxy was taken by a radio telescope. The added colors show the spiral arms of the galaxy.



Radio telescope